

Zhichao Chen/ Ziciu Can (Wade-Giles)

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EXPERIENCE	Post Doctoral Research Fellow, School of Intelligence Science and Technology, Peking University July 2025–2027 (Expected) Supervised by Prof. Zhouchen Lin on optimal control-based machine learning system analysis - Theoretically derived and analyzed the bottleneck of diffusion models within optimal control. - Directors of the “China Postdoctoral Science Foundation” (Grant No. 2025M781449). - Boya Postdoctoral Fellowship. Doctor of Philosophy Candidate, College of Control Science and Engineering, Zhejiang University Oct 2020–June 2025 Supervised by Prof. Zhihuan Song and Prof. Zhiqiang Ge on industrial process data analytics - Theoretically derived graph mining and utilization of industrial process. - Derive latent variable learning algorithm from the perspective of optimization/control theory. - Understanding and Improving Bayesian inference from the perspective of information geometry. Research Intern, Microsoft Research AI4Science Asia Apr 2023–Oct 2023 Supervised by Prof. Chang Liu and Prof. Bin Shao on solving Schrödinger equation with normalizing flow model. - Development of normalizing flow algorithm. - Code-base reformulation Research Intern, Ant Group Aug 2021–Jan 2023 Supervised by Mr. Leilei Ding, Miss Jianmin Huang and Prof. Wei Chu on cumulative time-series forecasting and large scale multivariate anomaly detection & diagnosis. - Development of time-series forecasting paper for “red-package” business. - Development of anomaly diagnosis algorithm for applet monitoring (full-stack). Undergraduate, School of Chemical Engineering and Technology, Sun Yat-sen University 2016–2020 Supervised by Prof. Chang He and Prof. Haoshui Yu on chemical process optimization using GAMS. - Synthesize of “organic Rankine cycle-heat integration-wastewater desalination” Coupled System
EDUCATION	Ph.D. Control Theory & Engineering, Zhejiang University (exp.) 2025 B.S. Chemical Engineering & Technology, Sun Yat-sen University 2020
SERVICES	Reviewer, Conference: ICLR-2024/2025/2026 ICML-2023/2024/2025/2026, NeurIPS-2024/2025/2026, AISTATS-2025, AAAI-2025/2026, WWW 2025 . Journal: IEEE TNNLS, IEEE TPAMI, IEEE TII, IEEE TSMC-S
AWARDS	Gold Reviewer Award, ICML 2026 Program Chairs 2026 Undergraduate National Scholarship, Ministry of Education (China) 2018,2019 The First Prize Scholarship of Sun Yat-sen University, Sun Yat-sen University 2017,2018,2019 One Hundred Outstanding Students of Sun Yat-sen University, Sun Yat-sen University 2021 The First Prize Scholarship, Zhejiang University 2020,2021 The SUPCON Scholarship, Zhejiang University 2024 The BYD Scholarship, Zhejiang University 2024
COMPETENCES	Languages Chinese (<i>native</i>), English (CET-6, 533)

FIRST-AUTHORED PUBLICATIONS (ACCEPTED & IN REVISION)

- [1] Exploiting Electrolyzer Flexibility Cross Multiscale Energy Markets. *ACS Energy Letters* (In Revision, IF=17.5, JCR-Q1), 2026.
- [2] Rethinking the Model Specification for Probabilistic Latent Variable Models: A Finite-Horizon Optimal Control Approach. *Automatica* (In Revision, IF=6.2, JCR-Q1), 2026.
- [3] Rethinking the Flow-Based Gradual Domain Adaptation: A Semi-Dual Optimal Transport Perspective. *The Forty-third International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026), Main Track, Poster* (CCF-A), 2026.
- [4] Blending Data and Knowledge for Process Industrial Modeling Under Riemannian Preconditioned Bayesian Framework. *IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering* (CCF-A, IF=10.4, JCR-Q1)
- [5] Improving Data-Driven Inferential Sensor Modeling by Industrial Knowledge: A Bayesian Perspective. *IEEE Transactions on Systems, Man and Cybernetics: Systems* (CCF-B, IF=8.6, JCR-Q1)
- [6] Diffusion Model-based Numerical Tabular Data Imputation: A Wasserstein Gradient Flow Perspective. *The Thirty-Eighth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2024), Main Track, Poster* (CCF-A), 2024.
- [7] E²AG: Entropy-Regularized Ensemble Adaptive Graph for Industrial Soft Sensor Modeling. *IEEE/CAA Journal of Automatica Sinica* (Top-1, IF=15.3, JCR Q1, Regular Paper), 2024.
- [8] Analyzing and Improving Supervised Nonlinear Dynamical Probabilistic Latent Variable Model for Inferential Sensors. *IEEE Transactions on Industrial Informatics* (CCF-C, IF=11.7, JCR Q1, Regular Paper), 2024. doi: 10.1109/TII.2024.3435466
- [9] Variational Inference Over Graph: Knowledge Representation for Deep Process Data Analytics. *IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering* (CCF-A, IF=8.9, Regular Paper), 2023. doi: 10.1109/TKDE.2023.3327415
- [10] Unsupervised Anomaly Detection & Diagnosis: A Stein Variational Gradient Descent Approach. In: *CIKM'23* (CCF-B, Short Paper), Birmingham, England, 2023. doi: 10.1145/3583780.3615167
- [11] Monotonic Neural Ordinary Differential Equation: Time-series Forecasting for Cumulative Data. In: *CIKM'23* (CCF-B, Applied Research Paper), Birmingham, England, 2023. doi: 10.1145/3583780.3615487
- [12] Directed Acyclic Graphs With Tears. *IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence* vol. 4, no. 4, 972-983, 2023. doi: 10.1109/TAI.2022.3181115
- [13] Knowledge Automation Through Graph Mining, Convolution, and Explanation Framework: A Soft Sensor Practice. *IEEE Transactions on Industrial Informatics* (CCF-C, IF=11.7, JCR Q1, Regular Paper) vol. 18, no. 9, 6068-6078, 2022. doi: 10.1109/TII.2021.3127204
- [14] Stochastic optimization-based approach for simultaneous process design and HEN synthesis of tightly-coupled RO-ORC-HI systems under seasonal uncertainty. *Chemical Engineering Science* vol. 246, 116961, 2021. doi: 10.1016/j.ces.2021.116961

CORRESPONDING-AUTHORED PUBLICATIONS (ACCEPTED & MINOR REVISION)

- [1] FMT-I: Flexible Mass Transport for Noise-Resilient Missing Data Imputation. *IEEE/CAA Journal of Automatica Sinica* (In press, Top-1, IF=15.3, JCR Q1, Regular Paper), 2026.
- [2] Toward Intrinsically Calibrated Uncertainty Quantification in Industrial Data-Driven Models via Diffusion Sampler. *IEEE Transactions on Industrial Informatics* (CCF-C, IF=11.7, JCR Q1, Regular Paper). doi: 10.1109/TII.2026.3680957
- [3] Slack More, Predict Better: Proximal Relaxation for Probabilistic Latent Variable Model-Based Soft Sensors. *IEEE Transactions on Industrial Informatics* (CCF-C, IF=11.7, JCR Q1, Regular Paper). doi: 10.1109/TII.2026.3674530
- [4] SPOT-I: Similarity Preserved Optimal Transport for Industrial IoT Data Imputation. *IEEE Transac-*

tions on Industrial Informatics (CCF-C, IF=11.7, JCR Q1, Regular Paper). doi: 10.1109/TII.2024.3452241

- [5] LSPT-D: Local Similarity Preserved Transport for Direct Industrial Data Imputation. *IEEE Transactions on Automation Science and Engineering* (CCF-B, IF=5.9, JCR Q1, Regular Paper). doi: 10.1109/TASE.2024.3506835
- [6] Optimal Transport for Time Series Imputation. *The Thirteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025)* (Regular Paper).
- [7] AKGNN: When Adaptive Graph Neural Network Meets Kolmogorov-Arnold Network for Industrial Soft Sensors. *IEEE Transactions on Instrumentation and Measurement* (IF=5.6, JCR Q2, Regular Paper).

CO-AUTHORED
PUBLICATIONS
(ACCEPTED)

- [1] Unbiased Reward Modeling from Implicit Feedback for LLM Alignment. *The Forty-third International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2026), Main Track, Poster* (CCF-A), 2026.
- [2] Proximity matters: Local proximity enhanced balancing for treatment effect estimation. *Proceedings of the 31st ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (SIGKDD 2025), Research Article, Oral* (CCF-A), 2025.
- [3] Unbiased Recommender Learning from Implicit Feedback via Weakly Supervised Learning. *The Forty-second International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML 2025), Main Track, Poster* (CCF-A), 2025.
- [4] Optimal Transport for Treatment Effect Estimation. *The Thirty-Seventh Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2023), Main Track, Poster* (CCF-A), 2024.
- [5] ESCM²: Entire Space Counterfactual Multi-Task Model for Post-Click Conversion Rate Estimation. In: *Proceedings of the 45th International ACM SIGIR Conference on Research and Development in Information Retrieval (SIGIR 2022), Research Article, Oral* (CCF-A), Madrid, Spain , 2022. doi: 10.1145/3477495.3531972
- [6] TMoE-P: Toward the Pareto Optimum for Multivariate Soft Sensors. *IEEE Transactions on Automation Science and Engineering* (CCF-B, IF=5.9, JCR Q1, Regular Paper),2024. doi: 10.1109/TASE.2024.3504736
- [7] Entire Space Counterfactual Learning for Reliable Content Recommendations. *IEEE Transactions on Information Forensics and Security* (CCF-A, IF=6.3, JCR Q1, Regular Paper),2024. doi: 10.1109/TIFS.2024.3516584
- [8] Label Correlation Biases Direct Time Series Forecast. *The Thirteenth International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR 2025)* (Regular Paper),2025.

LEADING
PROJECT

- [1] China Postdoctoral Science Foundation funded project (China Postdoctoral Science Foundation), Grant No. 2025M781449.
 - Background: We aim to develop an imputation model for graph-structured data that accommodates diverse application scenarios.
 - Results: Approved, A 80 k-valued foundation was approved (2026.01-2027.12).

PARTICIPATED
FUNDING

- [1] Industrial Waste Heat Driven Waste Water Recovery (Sun Yat-sen University Undergraduate Science and Innovation Funding)
 - Background: Industrial process has been greatly confronted with inevitable waste heat and waste water. To this extend, how to handle these waste water throughout these waste heat from the perspective of process synthesis with the consideration of the waste water temperature uncertainty is an interesting problem.
 - Contribution: We model the waste heat-driven organic Rankine cycle process and reverse osmosis-based waste water processing plant rigorously in GAMS platform. On this basis, we

test the integrated system stability by a linear programming model relaxed from an mix-integer non linear programming problem.

- Results: Approved, With the help of the proposed model, the unit product cost of our designed system is lower than those of the conventional reverse osmosis system. We proposed 1 SCI journal paper, 1 EI journal paper, and 1 EI conference paper.

[2] Multi-source Heterogeneous and Low Quality Industrial Data Modeling & Fusion Methodology (National Natural Science Foundation of China), Grant No. 9216710003.

- Background: Industrial big data has been greatly confronted with low quality property for the existence of the measurement noise. Besides, due to the diversity of the process measurement instruments including but not limited to camera, sonar, etc, how to fuse different data source in the data-driven model to better support the downstream task is a crucial problem.
- Contribution: I wrote the full part “Project Basis and Research Content” (core part) of the foundation application form.
- Results: Approved, a 1, 040 k-valued natural science foundation was approved (2022.01-2024.12).